

Consumer price indices

Adjustments to the Harmonised Index of Consumer Prices



Since the reporting month of January 2026, comprehensive changes have been implemented in the Harmonised Index of Consumer Prices (HICP) as a whole and thus also in the HICP for Germany. The HICP was developed in the European Union (EU) to enable international comparisons of price changes and to summarize an overall inflation rate for Europe and the European Monetary Union. As of January 2026, the HICP will undergo significant changes. Above all the new ECOICOP Version 2 classification is being implemented in the HICP. While the revised classification structure follows international standards, it also entails substantial structural changes. In addition, the scope of the HICP was expanded to include games of chance. Further changes comprise the rescaling of the index base from 2015 to 2025 of the HICP reference year, in line with the regular decadal update. As usual, the annual update of the expenditure weights was implemented in January.

The first HICP publications following the adjustments were released as preliminary results by the Federal Statistical Office for Germany on [30 January 2026](#) and by Eurostat on [4 February 2026](#). In mid-February 2026, the final HICP results for the reference month of January 2026 were published. The ongoing monthly publications can be found in the [publication calendar](#). The HICP results are available in the respective databases:

- Current HICP results for Germany by the Federal Statistical Office via Database [Database GENESIS-Online](#).
- Historical results and partial results (2-, 3-, 4- and 5-digit) for all Member States, special breakdowns and aggregations are available at Eurostat under under ["Database"](#).

Since the reporting month of January 2026, Eurostat has also been publishing all Harmonised Indices of Consumer Prices (HICP) uniformly, including for Germany, with two decimal places. Since the reporting month of January 2026, the corresponding rates of change for the HICP have been calculated from index values with two decimal places and published by both Germany and Eurostat with one decimal place.

Additional information on the extensive changes to the HICP has been available on the Eurostat [website](#) since November 2025. Germany has also informed users about the upcoming changes, most recently in a short article published in the December 2025 issue of the German statistical journal ["Wirtschaft und Statistik"](#). The International Classification of Individual Consumption by Purpose (COICOP), which is used to compile consumption statistics by purpose, forms the basis for the European HICP. This classification was comprehensively revised and re-adopted by the United Nations in 2018. As a consequence, the European classification has been substantially updated and implemented as the European [COICOP \(ECOICOP\) Version 2](#). This modernisation directly affects consumer price statistics and has implications for collection index calculation and dissemination of HICP results.

The changes to the HICP resulting from the implementation of ECOICOP Version 2 mainly involve substantial structural shifts in addition to the updating and revision of goods.

These structural shifts are particularly evident in the former division 12. This has been split into two separate divisions: it continues in an amended division 12 "Insurance and financial services" and the newly created division 13 "Personal care, social services and other goods and services". In addition, divisions 08 "Information and telecommunications," 09 "Recreation, entertainment, sports, and culture," and 06 "Health care" have been comprehensively revised. At the same time, goods and services are now more clearly separated. Overall, the implementation of ECOICOP Version 2 represents the most extensive modernisation of the HICP classification since the index was first introduced.

The transition to COICOP 2018 and ECOICOP Version 2 classifications also affects the national Consumer Price Index (CPI), as the HICP and CPI are based on the same classification structure and data sources. For this reason, the national Classification (SEA, [in German](#)) was aligned with the international classification at an early stage. In addition, the CPI was compiled on the basis of SEA 2021 for the new 2025 survey catalogue. Information on the special effects of the transition to the 2025 survey catalogue is available online ([in German](#)). The full impact of the new classification on the CPI will become apparent as planned with the next CPI revision in 2028. Initial information on this can be found in chapter 5 of the WISTA article on the SEA 2021 changeover ([in German](#)).

In addition to the classification changes, the scope of the HICP has been expanded to include games of chance in line with Eurostat's methodological recommendations. While traditional lotteries have already been included in Germany's national CPI, games of chance were previously explicitly excluded from the HICP. Under the harmonised European approach, games of chance are now included on the basis of gross gaming revenue and payout ratios (the so-called New Zealand method). The implementation in Germany will be phased: lotteries and betting are included first, followed by games at a later stage. This represents a significant extension of HICP coverage, as games of chance account for a notable share of private household consumption expenditure in Germany and in many other member states.

Another change concerns the rescaling of the HICP to a new reference year. This rescaling is carried out every ten years. In accordance with [Implementing Regulation \(EU\) 2025/1182](#), the HICP reference year of the index base from 2015 to 2025 was updated. The change in the reference period improves the readability and interpretability of the index series.

In view of the scope of the changes to the HICP, the European Statistical Office Eurostat has prepared [comprehensive information on the changeover](#) and a comprehensive [question and answer document](#).

Additional note on the publication of the HICP with two decimal places

Since the reporting month of January 2026, Eurostat has been publishing the Harmonised Indices of Consumer Prices (HICP), sub-indices and special aggregates for all Member States and EU aggregates (e.g. for the euro area) uniformly with two decimal places. Previously, Eurostat had only reported one decimal place for some countries, including Germany. Since January 2026, the rates of change for indices, sub-indices and aggregates have been calculated from index values with two decimal places, but Eurostat continues to publish them with one decimal place.

The adjustments to the publication of the HICP by Eurostat contribute to a uniform presentation of the results between the individual EU member states.

The Federal Statistical Office currently continues to publish the HICP as a whole and the sub-indices with one decimal place. The inflation rate derived from the HICP is calculated in the same way as Eurostat, using index values with two decimal places, in order to avoid (rounding-related) discrepancies between the results published by Eurostat and those published by the Federal Statistical Office. Any differences in the index values are solely due to the presentation (two versus one decimal place).

If users calculate rates of change themselves from the index values shown with one decimal place, rounding differences from the published results are possible.

For the national consumer price index (CPI), the presentation of the indices and calculation of the rates of change remain unchanged with one decimal place in each case.

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